



fellows fellowssc <fellows@science-corps.org>

New Science Corps Fellow Application: Jeff Ojwach

1 message

Science Corps Web <eduversumdev@gmail.com>

Mon, Jul 20, 2020 at 6:01 PM

To: fellows@science-corps.org

Name

Jeff Ojwach

Gender

Male

Nationality

Kenyan

Emailojwachj@gmail.com**When did or will you finish your PhD?**

December 2021 expected completion

City, state, and country of residence

Western Cape, Cape Town, South Africa

University education

PhD Biodiversity and Conservation Biology, University of the Western Cape 2019-2021

MSc Microbiology cum laude University of KwaZulu-Natal 2016-2018

BSc Microbiology Honors Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture and Technology 2010-2014

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps Fellow? (max. 200 words)

I have extensive industry and research experiences that would enable me to successfully complete an industry or research Fellowship. My academic background is quite varied and distinctive. I have taken courses at the graduate and undergraduate levels in pharmacology, immunology, microbiology. I worked for a number of years in a university-based research facility

as a laboratory demonstrator. In this position, I conducted public and privately sponsored biomedical technology studies in the scientific areas of bacteriology and mycology. The strengths gained from this position help me teach students the real world skills that are necessary for being a scientist. I have used my past academic training and personal interests to create and adapt an entirely new curriculum for a high school, senior-level capstone science course in forensic science. I believe that my academic background is appropriate for the Corps Fellowship. I graduated with Master of Science Microbiology cum laude at the University of KwaZulu-Natal, South Africa. Here, I specialized in biocatalysis of enzymes with potential pharmacological and biotechnological applications. Further, I worked as a research assistant in the Catalysis and Peptides Unit (CPRU) at UKZN in Westville on cloning and expression of HIV proteins. In addition, I have submitted three manuscripts to high impact journals: Biocatalysis and Agricultural Biotechnology, Bioactive Carbohydrates and 3 Biotech. I want to continue building my research portfolio and the Corps Fellowship represents a great opportunity.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship (max. 200 words)

I am very much interested in Corps Fellowship because I have participated in a similar program in the past and found it personally rewarding and professionally fulfilling. Early on in my research career, I had the opportunity to participate in a project funded by the Wellcome Trust at the University of Glasgow. I was among nine Africans selected to be part of the Global Challenge Research Fund Fellowship which promotes the active involvement of emerging early career scientist from low income countries in biomedical research in order to bring knowledge of biomedical science and technological innovation and capacity building. For this program, I worked closely with a leading established professor of parasitology to understand biology of parasites such as Plasmodium falciparum, Leishmania and Trypanosoma. I was also involved with RNA isolation from cell culture, animal handling, rodent exposure to allergens, DNA extraction, Sybr-safe DNA electrophoresis, in vitro drug sensitivity assays with Plasmodium berghei, in vitro culture of parasites, fluorescence microscopy, gene cloning, protein trafficking and protein expression. Also, I did transfection, mutagenesis and gene knockouts on Plasmodium cell lines, culture maintenance, media preparation, cell transformations, and fluorescence-activated cell sorting for three parasite lines. This project gave me experience in molecular biology, and bioinformatics using various pipelines like CLC workbench in designing plasmid maps for my clones. I would like to duplicate and even expand upon the experiences and knowledge gained during this sojourn. The overall goal of my professional development plan is to continue growing as an emerging career scientist by adding real world experiences in biomedical sciences so that I may mentor other aspiring scientist from low and middle income countries. With my past experiences and future professional goals, the Corps Fellowship program fits perfectly into the natural progression of my professional development plan.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Academic scientist in academia
Doing science in industry
In science education

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (2 year) and long-term (10 year) future (max. 200 words)

This Corps Fellowship programs if selected will develop and build my expertise post my PhD. I am looking to become a full-time academic and early career researcher and continue my collaborations with the research leaders at research institutions such as Max Planck Institute and also build capacity in Africa where the burden of disease is high. In doing this I will be able to train and mentor other aspiring young researchers. I will be pleased to be part of the International Research School for Infectious Diseases and Immunity to develop strong international relations. In the long term ten year future I am looking to be a full professor of Microbiology and maybe win a Nobel prize in science.

CV/Resumé[Curriculum-Vitae-Jeff-Ojwach-2020.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?Other

If other, please specify.Graduate Student Network via gmail

Any extra comment or message.

To my knowledge, this Fellowship is very competitive. Despite the facts that it attracts only highly driven scientist, I am confident that my academic record, experience, professional goals and my enthusiasm will make me a strong candidate for a place in this Fellowship. I would be honored if you consider my application.

Sent from Science Corps